

- *Trim*: Any damage or missing pieces? Animals can be brutal to wood trim, and matching old trim can be difficult.
- *Lights and ceiling fans*: Turn on every switch to make sure they work. (Note: If the home is unoccupied and the power is turned off, this won't be possible.)
- *Stairs*: Walk up and down the stairs and touch every spindle on the railing. Do they seem sturdy or wobbly? Do the stairs creak? Are any parts missing?
- *Smells*: Has the home been smoked in? Are there musty odors indicating water infiltration?
- *Layout*: Consider the layout of the whole house. Where are the bathrooms? How open is the living space? Does the house flow, or are there walls or angles that don't work?

Kitchen

- *Cabinets and drawers*: Open every cabinet and drawer, then close them. Do they move smoothly? Does anything prevent the doors or drawers from being used easily? Check the condition of the cabinet faces. If they were painted, was it a quality job? Is there adequate storage? Do you have enough drawers?
- *Oven*: Open and inspect the oven. Does the door open slowly, indicating the springs still work? What is the condition of the oven?
- *Stove*: Turn on each burner individually to check that they all work.
- *Refrigerator*: Open the refrigerator and freezer doors. Do they open easily? (Note: Exercise extreme caution if the home is vacant and appears to have been vacant for some time. You don't want to stick your head inside a full, unplugged fridge. The smell might kill you.)
- *Dishwasher*: Open and inspect the dishwasher. Do the springs work on the dishwasher door? Check the floor around the dishwasher for evidence of past leaks. The dishwasher should empty into a garbage disposal, so check under the sink for the presence of a disposal.
- *Faucet*: Run the water in the sink. How is the water pressure?
- *Garbage disposal*: Does the garbage disposal run? (Don't forget to turn on the water before you test it.)
- *Hood*: Turn on the range hood fan and light to make sure they work. Peek underneath to check for filth—this is a commonly overlooked